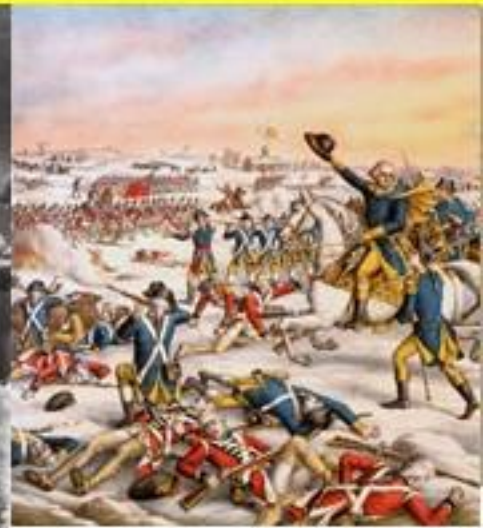


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 31

**PERIOD BETWEEN THE TWO
WORLD WARS - 2**

ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

i AALAND ISLANDS

- 1 These islands lie between Sweden and Finland.
- 2 Both Finland and Aaland once belonged to Sweden.
- 3 On the ownership of Aaland Islands, there came a dispute between Sweden and Finland in 1920.
- 4 A special Commission of the League investigated the case and settled the dispute in favour of Finland.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

ii MOSUL BOUNDARY DISPUTE

- 1 This was a question related to the frontier dispute between Turkey and the Great Britain's mandated territory of Iraq.
- 2 Both the parties claimed Mosul Villayet which was rich in oil.
- 3 Both failed to come to an agreement on this boundary line.
- 4 Ultimately the League Council gave its final judgment on the subject.
- 5 In June 1926, a treaty was made between Turkey and Great Britain by which a small part of the Villayet was given to Turkey.
- 6 The revised boundary was recognised as definite.
- 7 Some royalty from Mosul oil fields were given to Turkey.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

iii EUPEN AND MALMADY

- 1 In 1920 and 1921 Germany protested to the League of Nations against the decision of giving Euphen and Malmady to Belgium.
- 2 The League Council discussed the matter in September 1920 and wrote to the government that its decision regarding the transfer of Euphen and Malmedy to Belgium was final.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

iv CURFU INCIDENT

- 1 In August 1923, an Italian general and two officers were murdered on Greek soil.
- 2 The Italians demanded apologies and reparations too for the crime.
- 3 Greece refused to accept the demands of Italy.
- 4 Hence Italy occupied the island of Curfu.
- 5 In this dispute Britain and France mediated and brought about a compromise between Italy and Greece.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

**DISPUTE BETWEEN GREECE
AND BULGARIA**

- 1** There was a border dispute between Greece and Bulgaria.
- 2** In 1925 a Greek army commander was murdered.
- 3** The Greek army marched in to Bulgaria.
- 4** The League Council requested Britain and France to investigate this affair.

- 5** The Greek forces were withdrawn and Greece was asked to pay compensation to Bulgaria for violation of her territory on a scale to be fixed by a League Commission.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

DISPUTE BETWEEN GREAT
BRITAIN AND FRANCE

vi

- 1 In 1921, there was dispute between France and Great Britain over the nationality question in Tunis and Morocco.
- 2 The matter went to the Court of International Justice.
- 3 However, the dispute was decided by mutual negotiations between the foreign ministers of the two countries.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

vii NON-POLITICAL WORK

- 1** The League did also a lot of non-political work.
- 2** A slavery convention met at Geneva in 1925. In 1932 it was decided to set up a permanent **Slavery Commission**.
- 3** The **Financial Commission** was responsible for the issue and **supervision of various League Loans** for Austria, Hungary, Greece etc.
- 4** The league also set up in 1923 the Health Organisation with a Health Committee and a secretariat.



ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

vii NON-POLITICAL WORK

- 5 It did good in fighting diseases such as Malaria, Smallpox, Rabies, Cancer, Tuberculosis and heart diseases etc. It helped nations to improve national health. It organised technical conferences.
- 6 The League did commentate Common Wealth work in the field of control of traffic in dangerous drugs, peasant reforms, suppression of trade in obscene literature.



FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- The League failed in its main object of maintaining peace in the world.
- In spite of its efforts for two decades, the whole world was involved in war again in 1939.
- There are many causes for its failure.

i ABSENCE OF MAJOR POWERS

- The major powers like USA and USSR were not members of the League of Nations.
- This was a serious defect.



FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

ii TREATY OF REVENGE

- 1** It was unfortunate that the Covenant of the League of Nations was made a part and parcel of the peace settlement.
- 2** It would have been better if it had been kept separate.
- 3** There were many states which considered the Treaty of Versailles as a treaty of revenge and were not prepared to ratify the same.
- 4** By not ratifying the treaty, they were refused to be members the League.
- 5** The absence of great powers [USA and USSR] in the international organisation weakened the League.
- 6** Japan, Germany and Italy had left the League.



FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

DOMINATION OF VICTORIOUS COUNTRIES

iii

- There was also a feeling among the nations that the League of Nations was fully dominated by the victorious countries of World War I especially of France and England.
- The result was that the other states began to doubt about the working of the League of Nations.

iv

HUMILIATION OF GERMANY

- The countries like Germany were humiliated by the victorious countries.
- Germany was compelled to pay war reparations when it was suffering from economic difficulties.
- Hence there were no chances of peace.

FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

✓ RISE OF DICTATORS

- 1** After World War I, in Europe there came situations for the rise of dictatorships in Italy, Japan and Germany.

JAPAN

- 2**
- Japan in the Far East conquered Manchuria.
 - The League was not also in a position to condemn the action of Japan.
 - Japan was also prepared to give up the membership of the League.

ITALY

- 3**
- In Italy there was Fascist Dictatorship.
 - This had preached the people of Italy narrow nationalism.
 - Italy captured Abyssinia.
 - When the League questioned the conquest of Italy on Abyssinia, it left the League.



FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

v RISE OF DICTATORS

GERMANY

- 1 Germany too was not prepared to accept the commitments under the Treaty of Versailles.
- 2 In Germany too there was Nazi dictatorship.
- 3 Hitler preached pseudo patriotism.
- 4 He also spoke about the superiority of German race over other races.
- 5 He wanted to expand Germany's sway over Austria and Poland.
- 6 He made conquests over these countries.
- 7 Defying the provisions of the Treaty of Versailles he increased the armaments.
- 8 When this was questioned in the League, Germany left the League.



FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

vi SMALL NATIONS LOST THEIR FAITH

- This was on the working of the League.
- They felt that the League of Nations had no power to control the aggressive activities of the big powers.



vii FALL OF WEIMAR REPUBLIC

- France's insistence of forcing Germany to pay the war reparation at the time of its economic crisis had disastrous effects on the politics of the country.
- This contributed to the downfall of the Weimar Republic.
- This led to the rise of Hitler in Germany and the latter was responsible for the failure of the League.

FAILURE OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

viii DISINTEGRATION OF LEAGUE

- 1** The birth of the League of Nations on the ruins of the First World War was welcomed.
- 2** However, the member states of the League did not cooperate.
- 3** As a result, the League failed in its mission.
- 4** Thus, the Second World War broke out.
- 5** Finally, UNO was established on the disintegration of the League.



QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Treaty of Versailles resulted in the second world war. Do you agree with this statement?

250 words

2. Examine the achievements of the League of Nations and analyse the causes for the failure of the League of Nations.

250 words

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